# Properties of materials

☞ **1** Read the passage below and underline the correctly spelled word in each pair.

The word **(properties, propertees)** is used to describe the characteristics of a particular material. Different materials have different properties. There are lots of different words that can be used to describe the properties of an object. A **(flexable/flexible)** object is able to bend without breaking. Another object may be **(ridged/rigid)**, which is the opposite of flexible. If you cannot see through an object, it is **(opaque/opake)**. Objects that you can see through, such as windows, are **transparent**. Rubber bands are **elastic** because they can **(stretch/strech)** and then return to their original shape. **Absorbency** is a property of sponges – that's why we use them to clean up spills. Metals are good **conductors** because they allow heat and **(electrisitee/electricity)** to pass through them.

**2** Match each property with its description.

| | |
|---|---|
| absorbent | does not change shape easily |
| good insulator | stretches then returns to original shape |
| transparent | can be seen through |
| elastic | soaks up liquids |
| rigid | does not allow heat or electricity to pass through easily |
| good conductor | cannot be seen through |
| opaque | allows electricity or heat to flow through it |

**3** Use the notes below to write a paragraph about the properties of plastic.

- does not conduct electricity
- strong and lightweight
- does not corrode easily
- used to insulate electrical cords
- can be moulded into different shapes
- good insulator of heat

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